

· OPENCLAW COURSE · LESSON N-8

· Troubleshooting · 3 Causes, 3 Fixes

Telegram:

Bot

Muted

in the Group

Why

the bot

works

in DM

but

ignores the

group ·

and how

to solve

in 10

minutes.

Almost

always

DURATION

10 min

LEVEL

Intermediate

PRE-REQ

Bot working in DM

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01 The 3 Causes

Any one of them is enough for the bot to be muted. It can be all 3 at the same time.

- Cause 1 · Privacy Mode ENABLED in BotFather

By default, Telegram creates bots with "privacy mode" ENABLED. The bot DOES NOT RECEIVE group messages · it only receives messages that start with /command or that directly mention the bot with @username. Most common.

- Cause 2 · groupPolicy not configured in OpenClaw

Even if the bot receives the messages, OpenClaw has a security layer own: by default, it does not process messages from groups unless you configure explicitly.

- Cause 3 · Chat ID is not on the allowlist

If you used groupPolicy = allowlist, you need to add the chat ID of the group specific. Without the correct ID, OpenClaw ignores messages even with everything configured.

- Quick Test: What is your cause?

- Send /start in the group:

- Bot responds to /start but ignores normal messages ·

Cause 1

(Privacy Mode)

- Bot does not respond to anything, not even /start · it could be Cause 2 or 3
- Bot works in DM, totally muted in the group · Follow flowchart

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02 Fix 1 · Privacy Mode

03 Fix 2 · groupPolicy

BotFather · Disable Privacy Mode

CAUSE 1

Open Telegram and talk to @BotFather

Send: /setprivacy

BotFather will list your bots · select yours

Choose: Disable

Confirmation: "Success! Privacy mode is disabled."

·CRITICAL · Remove and re-add the bot to the group!

After changing the privacy mode, you need to
remove the bot from the group and add it back

. Telegram only applies the new configuration when the bot enters the
group. If the bot was already there, the change will not work.

1

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Configure groupPolicy in OpenClaw

CAUSE 2 + 3

2

Recommended policy: allowlist (only authorized groups)

openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupPolicy allowlist

Add group chat ID (see section below to find out the ID)

openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupAllowlist "[-100XXXXXXXXXX]"

If you have more than one group:

openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupAllowlist "[-100111111111, -100222222222]"

To allow any group (less secure, not recommended):

openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupPolicy open

bash

·How to find the Group Chat ID

Add the bot to the group, send any message and check the logs:

·Alternative: bot @userinfobot

Add @userinfobot to the group, send /start , it returns the ID of the group automatically.

openclaw gateway logs | grep "chat_id"

Output: Received message from chat_id: -1001234567890, user: João

Group Chat IDs start with -100

bash

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04 dmPolicy vs groupPolicy

Common confusion · two independent guardians:

05 Diagnostic Flow

Bot in group but not responding?

.

... [1] Privacy mode ENABLED?

- Test: `/start` in group
- If it responds to `/start` but ignores normal messages · Privacy mode ACTIVE
- FIX: BotFather · `/setprivacy` · Disable · Remove + re-add bot

.

... [2] groupPolicy configured?

- Test: `openclaw config get channels.telegram.groupPolicy`
- If it returns empty or "none" · not configured
- FIX: `openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupPolicy allowlist`

.

... [3] Chat ID in allowlist?

- Test: `openclaw config get channels.telegram.groupAllowlist`
- Check if the group ID is on the list
- FIX: `openclaw config set ...groupAllowlist "[-100XXXXXXX]"`

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... [4] Still doesn't work?

`openclaw gateway logs | tail -100`

`openclaw gateway restart`

06 Complete Configuration

DMPOLICY

GROUPOPOLICY

Controls

Direct Messages (DM/private)

Messages in groups

Default

allowlist

not configured

Scope

1-to-1 with you

Many users in the chat

Risk

Someone commanding your agent

Bot active in unauthorized groups

```
# 1. BotFather: /setprivacy · Disable (no Telegram)
# 2. Remove bot from the group and add it back
# 3. Configure policy
openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupPolicy allowlist
# 4. Add chat ID
openclaw config set channels.telegram.groupAllowlist "[-100XXXXXXXXXX]"
# 5. Verify
openclaw config get channels.telegram.groupPolicy
openclaw config get channels.telegram.groupAllowlist
# 6. Restart and check logs
openclaw gateway restart
openclaw gateway logs | tail -30
bash
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pg. 4
```

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07 Common Mistakes

Bot responds to /start but ignores normal messages

Cause: Privacy mode ENABLED. Fix: BotFather · /setprivacy · Disable · remove and re-add bot to the group.

Bot doesn't respond at all in the group

Cause: groupPolicy not configured. Fix:

`openclaw config set`

`channels.telegram.groupPolicy allowlist`

groupPolicy configured but still doesn't respond

Cause: Chat ID is not in the allowlist. Fix: Add the correct ID. Verify via logs: `openclaw`

`gateway logs | grep chat_id`

After changing privacy mode, still mute

Bot is still in the group with the old config. Fix: Remove the bot from the group and add it back · required.

Invalid Chat ID

Copied the wrong ID. Check in the logs: `openclaw gateway logs | grep chat_id` . Group IDs start with -100 .

· Topics (Forum Mode)

If your group uses topics, the bot needs to be admin to access all of them. For complete forum mode configuration, see the

Extra Lesson C

.

· Final Checklist

Privacy mode disabled in BotFather (/setprivacy · Disable)

Bot removed and re-added to the group after change

Group Chat ID discovered (starts with -100...)

groupPolicy = allowlist configured

Chat ID added to groupAllowlist

Gateway restarted

Test: message sent in the group · bot replied ·

..

NEXT CLASS

Module 5 · Integrations and Skills

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